

Psalms 69

The Waters Are Come In Unto My Soul

Save me, O God; for the waters are come in unto my soul

KJV · Standalone study handout

1 · THE WORD (KJV)

- 1 Save me, O God; for the waters are come in unto my soul.
- 2 I sink in deep mire, where there is no standing: I am come into deep waters, where the floods overflow me.
- 3 I am weary of my crying: my throat is dried: mine eyes fail while I wait for my God.
- 4 They that hate me without a cause are more than the hairs of mine head: they that would destroy me, being mine enemies wrongfully, are mighty: then I restored that which I took not away.
- 5 O God, thou knowest my foolishness; and my sins are not hid from thee.
- 6 Let not them that wait on thee, O Lord GOD of hosts, be ashamed for my sake: let not those that seek thee be confounded for my sake, O God of Israel.
- 7 Because for thy sake I have borne reproach; shame hath covered my face.
- 8 I am become a stranger unto my brethren, and an alien unto my mother's children.
- 9 For the zeal of thine house hath eaten me up; and the reproaches of them that reproached thee are fallen upon me.
- 10 When I wept, and chastened my soul with fasting, that was to my reproach.
- 11 I made sackcloth also my garment; and I became a proverb to them.
- 12 They that sit in the gate speak against me; and I was the song of the drunkards.
- 13 But as for me, my prayer is unto thee, O LORD, in an acceptable time: O God, in the multitude of thy mercy hear me, in the truth of thy salvation.
- 14 Deliver me out of the mire, and let me not sink: let me be delivered from them that hate me, and out of the deep waters.
- 15 Let not the waterflood overflow me, neither let the deep swallow me up, and let not the pit shut her mouth upon me.
- 16 Hear me, O LORD; for thy lovingkindness is good: turn unto me according to the multitude of thy tender mercies.
- 17 And hide not thy face from thy servant; for I am in trouble: hear me speedily.
- 18 Draw nigh unto my soul, and redeem it: deliver me because of mine enemies.
- 19 Thou hast known my reproach, and my shame, and my dishonour: mine adversaries are all before thee.
- 20 Reproach hath broken my heart; and I am full of heaviness: and I looked for some to take pity, but there was none; and for comforters, but I found none.
- 21 They gave me also gall for my meat; and in my thirst they gave me vinegar to drink.
- 22 Let their table become a snare before them: and that which should have been for their welfare, let it become a trap.
- 23 Let their eyes be darkened, that they see not; and make their loins continually to shake.
- 24 Pour out thine indignation upon them, and let thy wrathful anger take hold of them.
- 25 Let their habitation be desolate; and let none dwell in their tents.
- 26 For they persecute him whom thou hast smitten; and they talk to the grief of those whom thou hast wounded.
- 27 Add iniquity unto their iniquity: and let them not come into thy righteousness.
- 28 Let them be blotted out of the book of the living, and not be written with the righteous.
- 29 But I am poor and sorrowful: let thy salvation, O God, set me up on high.
- 30 I will praise the name of God with a song, and will magnify him with thanksgiving.
- 31 This also shall please the LORD better than an ox or bullock that hath horns and hoofs.
- 32 The humble shall see this, and be glad: and your heart shall live that seek God.
- 33 For the LORD heareth the poor, and despiseth not his prisoners.
- 34 Let the heaven and earth praise him, the seas, and every thing that moveth therein.
- 35 For God will save Zion, and will build the cities of Judah: that they may dwell there, and have it in possession.
- 36 The seed also of his servants shall inherit it: and they that love his name shall dwell therein.

2 · CONTEXT

One of the most extensive personal laments in the Psalter, quoted repeatedly in the New Testament of Christ's sufferings (zeal for God's house, John 2:17; hated without cause, John 15:25; gall and vinegar at the cross, Matt 27:34,48; table become a snare applied to unbelieving Israel, Rom 11:9–10). Henry reads David's own drowning distress, likely from persecution tied to zeal for the sanctuary, as a shadow of the greater sufferings of Christ, who fulfills the pattern of innocent suffering for righteousness' sake. MacArthur-style notes caution that the imprecatory section (22–28) functions as covenant-lawsuit language against persistent, unrepentant enemies of God's anointed, not personal vindictiveness.

3 · VERSE-BY-VERSE COMMENTARY

The notes below cover the whole chapter in one place—read with the KJV text above.

Verse 1-4

"Save me, O God; for the waters are come in unto my soul. I sink in deep mire... I am weary of my crying... They that hate me without a cause are more than the hairs of mine head." Overwhelming, drowning distress is described physically—exhaustion of voice and eyes—compounded by hatred he did not provoke.

Verse 5-9

"O God, thou knowest my foolishness... let not them that wait on thee, O Lord God of hosts, be ashamed for my sake... the zeal of thine house hath eaten me up." He fears his own failures might discourage other worshipers, yet the deepest cause of his suffering is devotion to God's house, not personal sin—words later applied directly to Christ.

Verse 10-12

"When I wept, and chastened my soul with fasting... I made sackcloth my garment... I was the song of the drunkards." Sincere spiritual discipline becomes public mockery—devotion itself invites ridicule.

Verse 13-15

"But as for me, my prayer is unto thee... Let not the waterflood overflow me, neither let the deep swallow me up." Amid mockery, prayer continues undeterred, pleading specifically against being overwhelmed entirely.

Verse 16-18

"Hear me, O LORD; for thy lovingkindness is good... hide not thy face from thy servant... draw nigh unto my soul." Appeal rests wholly on God's character, asking for nearness in the midst of distance and shame.

Verse 19-21

"Thou hast known my reproach, and my shame, and my dishonour... reproach hath broken my heart... they gave me gall to eat; and in my thirst they gave me vinegar to drink." God's full knowledge of his humiliation is affirmed even as the specific details become strikingly prophetic of the crucifixion.

Verse 22-25

"Let their table become a snare... let their eyes be darkened, that they see not... Pour out thine indignation upon them." Strong covenant-lawsuit language calls for judicial reversal on persistent, unrepentant persecutors of God's righteous sufferer.

Verse 26-28

"For they persecute him whom thou hast smitten... let them be blotted out of the book of the living." The imprecation escalates to ultimate exclusion for those who compound cruelty against one already afflicted by God's own hand.

Verse 29-33

"But I am poor and sorrowful: let thy salvation, O God, set me up... I will praise the name of God with a song... This also shall please the LORD better than an ox or bullock... the humble shall see this, and be glad." A turn to worship insists that sincere praise pleases God more than costly ritual sacrifice—present even amid unresolved suffering.

Verse 34-36

"Let the heaven and earth praise him, the seas... For God will save Zion, and will build the cities of Judah... they that love his name shall dwell therein." The psalm broadens from personal rescue to the certain future restoration of Zion and Judah, closing in communal hope.

4 · MEANING & APPLICATION

Meaning.

Innocent suffering for zeal toward God's house—met with mockery, betrayal, and physical torment—finds its fullest meaning in Christ, who bore reproach that was not His own; yet even amid unresolved anguish, sincere praise pleases God more than sacrifice, and personal lament ultimately widens into confidence in Zion's certain restoration.

Application for life today.

When devotion to God invites ridicule rather than admiration, remember David—and ultimately Christ—walked this road before you; you are not alone in being mocked for taking God seriously. Bring "waters... come in unto my soul" language honestly to God rather than minimizing overwhelming distress. Let praise remain possible even when circumstances are unresolved, since

sincere worship pleases God more than any performance or sacrifice could.

5 · REFLECT & RESPOND

Write your answers in the space below. There are no “right length” answers—honesty before God is the aim.

1. Where has zeal for God's house or God's ways brought you reproach rather than praise, as in verses 7–9?

2. How does seeing this psalm fulfilled in Christ's suffering deepen your reading of your own hard seasons?

3. What would it look like to offer God a "song" of praise (v. 30) even while your circumstances remain like "deep waters"?

Name: _____ Date: _____ Group / Church: _____

Sources: King James Version (public domain); Matthew Henry, Commentary on the Whole Bible (themes summarized); Expository themes consistent with MacArthur Study Bible tradition (paraphrased, not quoted). Scripture: King James Version (public domain).